

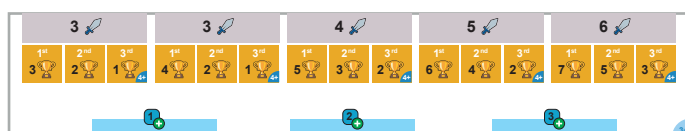
ICE CAVE

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In Ice Cave, you will make 5 expeditions to the fascinating ice caves of Iceland, one per year, in search of colored crystals and at the same time, trying to fight off the trolls inside. Ice caves completely change every year, as the ice always melts on Spring and freezes back on Winter. Crystals that were once in one location will be somewhere else when you make a new expedition, as the tiles you open to form the cave are randomized. Deal with that the best way you can to win the game.

Components



1 double-sided central board



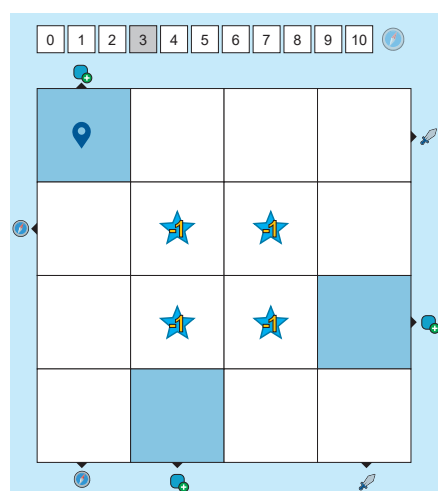
5 compass tokens



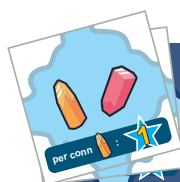
30 trophy tokens
(20 simple, 10 "x5")



1 1st player token



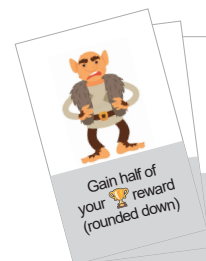
5 player boards (one per player)



5 sets of 7 initial tiles
(1 set per player)



24 tier 1 tiles



10 troll cards



24 tier 2 tiles

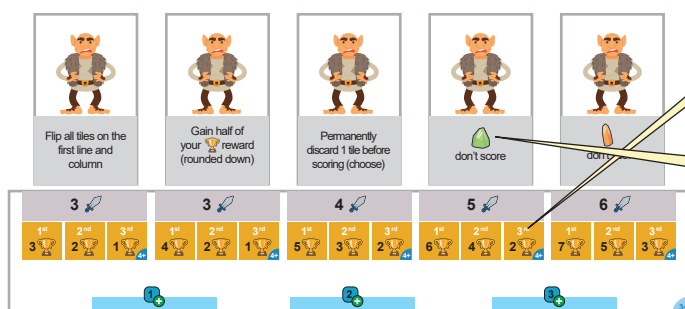


24 tier 3 tiles



5 bags (1 per player)

Central setup



Place the central board on the table. Use the front side for 2 players, or the back side for other player counts.

Shuffle the troll cards and place 5 face up in the spots above the central board. The rest won't be used in this game.

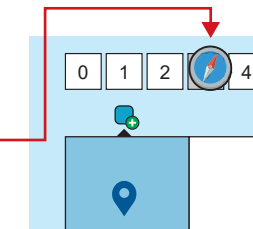


Separately shuffle the 3 tiers of tiles. Reveal 3 of each tier and place them on their corresponding spots below the board. Create a face down pile for each tier, and place them nearby.

Place the trophy tokens nearby.

Player setup

Give each player an equal set of 7 initial tiles and a bag, and place the whole set inside it. Give each player a player board (place it in front of you). Place a  token on the 3rd spot of the compass track above your board. Choose one player to get the  1st player token.



Goal of the game

Ice Cave is played in 5 expeditions / rounds. In each one you'll all simultaneously explore your own ice caves. You'll blindly take cave tiles from your bag and place them in your player board, starting in the top left corner and then always side by side with the previous tile.

You'll try to position them to score as many points as possible (following the scoring conditions from the tiles themselves) and gather swords to fight off the troll.

After everyone ends their exploration, you'll get trophies according to how you fared in comparison to other players. Most trophies by the end of the 5th expedition wins.

Game round

In each round, players will follow the steps below:

1. Exploration (simultaneous play):

Reveal a tile at random from your bag. If you don't like what you got, you can spend a  to reveal another one (you may do this as many times as you want).

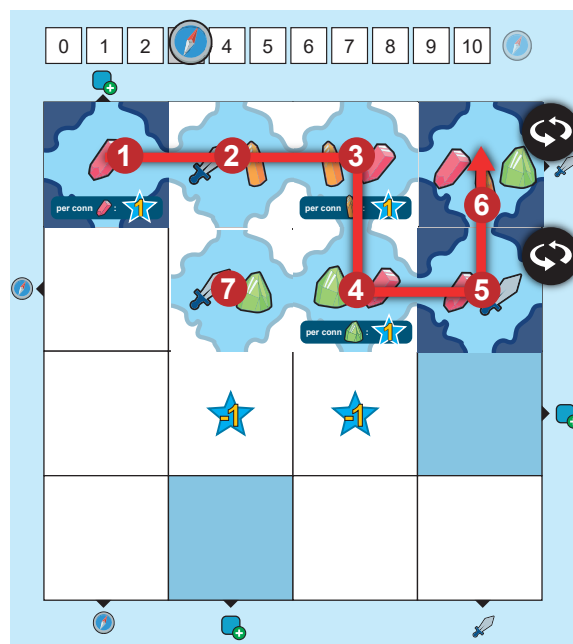
Choose one of the tiles you revealed (if you used a ) to place on the top left corner, on the spot marked with a . This is the entrance for the cave.

Take the ones you didn't choose (if any) and drop them back inside your bag.

All your following tiles must be placed side by side with the previous one, unless there are no empty spaces next to the previous tile (you're locked in). In that case, you can place your next tile side by side with any other tile already placed.

If at any moment you place 2 tiles with **thin ice (dark blue corners)** side by side, they both crumble. Immediately flip both tiles on your board. After flipping them, continue taking tiles as usual.

You may end your exploration whenever you want (to avoid placing 2 thin ice tiles together, for example), but if you reveal a tile, you must place it. When you decide to stop, or when you took all tiles from the bag, wait for others to finish their explorations.



Example of a first exploration:

1: First tile must be placed on the  slot. Beware, it's already a thin ice tile!

2: Next tile must be connected to the first, so it must either go on the right or below. You choose to place it on the right. Since it's not thin ice, you don't need to flip tiles.

3, 4 & 5. The next tiles must again be connected to the previous ones. The 3rd goes to the right of the 2nd, the 4th goes below the 3rd, and the 5th goes to the right of the 4th.

6: The next tile can be above or below the 5th. You decide to place it above, but it's also a thin ice tile, so both the 5th and 6th tile are immediately flipped .

7: The 6th tile has no empty slots around it, so you can place the 7th anywhere connected to the tiles on the board. You decide to place it below the 2nd tile.

2. Rewards:

If you have any., collect all  and  on the unflipped tiles.

If you placed a tile in a spot with a  pointing to a  or a , also collect it (even if the tile was flipped)

There are no tokens for the , you'll just add one more to your total when you go fight off the troll.

There are also some spots with arrows pointing to a  symbol. Those will only be considered later in the round.

3. Fight off the troll:

Add up the  on your longest sequence of side by side unflipped tiles that have at least 1 . Add to that the  you got from the board rewards.

If the total is equal or higher than the number of  below the troll card, you have successfully fought him off.

If not, apply the troll penalty before the next phases (they might reduce your score, flip tiles, and other effects).

Each player must fight the troll off by themselves, the  totals are not added up.

4. Score:

Some tiles in your board will have scoring conditions. On the set of initial tiles, there are 3. Each scores for the number of crystals from a specific color connected to that tile (directly or indirectly).

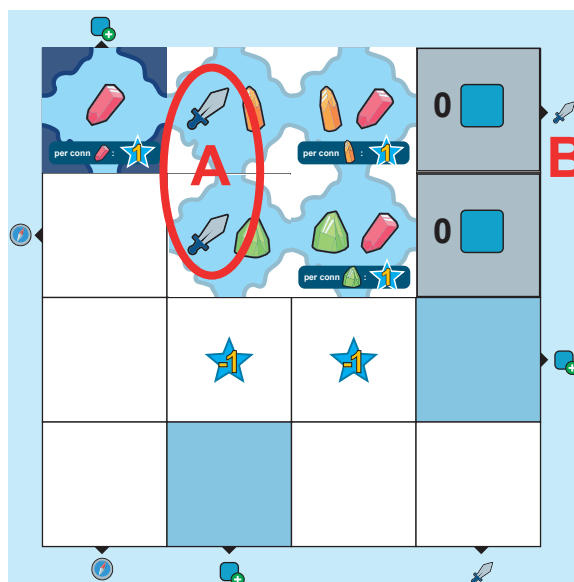
 The crystals in the tile itself also score. But if you have a sequence of crystals of a color unconnected to the scoring tile, it will not score. Also, flipped tiles don't score.

In the center of your board, there are four slots with . Lose 1 point for each uncovered one.

The players with most, 2nd most and 3rd most points get the number of  indicated on the board, according to the current round. Tied players all score the position they tied for, but then the next rank is not scored.

 **3 players:** no one scores for 3rd place.

2 players: you'll also play against an automated player, who scores a fixed amount in each round (shown on the 2-player side of the board). It doesn't get trophies, but it will stop other players from getting them if it has the most or 2nd most points

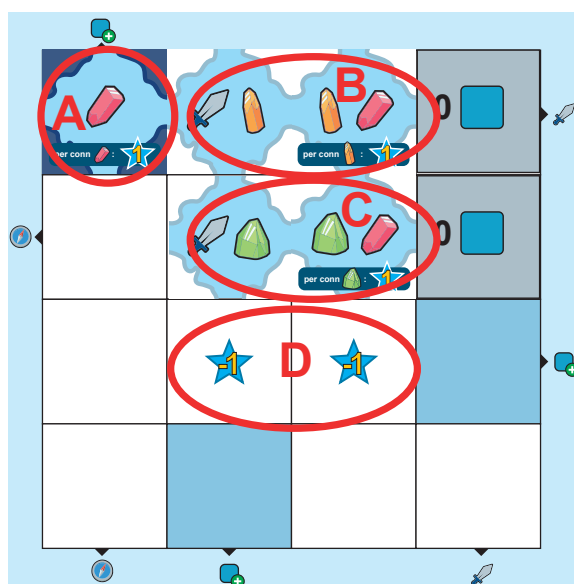


Example of fighting off a troll:

After the end of the exploration steps (in which 2 tiles were flipped), you have to fight the troll. On the first exploration, you need to have at least 3  to beat it.

And you achieved it: you've got a set of 2 connected  on the 2nd column (A), and 1 more  from having occupied the top right slot (B), for a total of 3.

If the  in the 2nd column were not connected, your total would be 2, and you'd have to take the punishment of the troll.



Example of scoring:

Tile A scores just 1 point, as there's only 1  connected to it (in the same tile).

Tile B scores 2 points, from having 2 connected .

Tile C also scores 2 points, from having 2 connected .

D: Lose 2 points from not covering 2 of the central slots.

Your total score was $1+2+2-2=3$. If your neighbor had 5 points and the other player had 2, you'd be second, and since it's the 1st round, you'd get 2 points.

5. Get new tiles:

Starting from the player with the 🧑‍🚒 1st player marker, each player will get one tile from the display on the center. There are 3 columns. The first one has tier 1 tiles, the second has tier 2 (stronger) and the third has tier 3 tiles (strongest).

You can only get a tile from tier 2 if you covered 2  slots. If you covered all 3  slots, you can get a tile from tier 3.

If you don't like anything, you may spend a  to reset a column before taking a tile (but not after). Discard the 3 tiles there and open 3 new ones.

After taking a tile, immediately refill the display.

6. Fill your bag.

Place all your tiles, including the one you just got, back in your bag.

After everyone has taken one, give the 🧑‍🚒 to the next player in clockwise order.

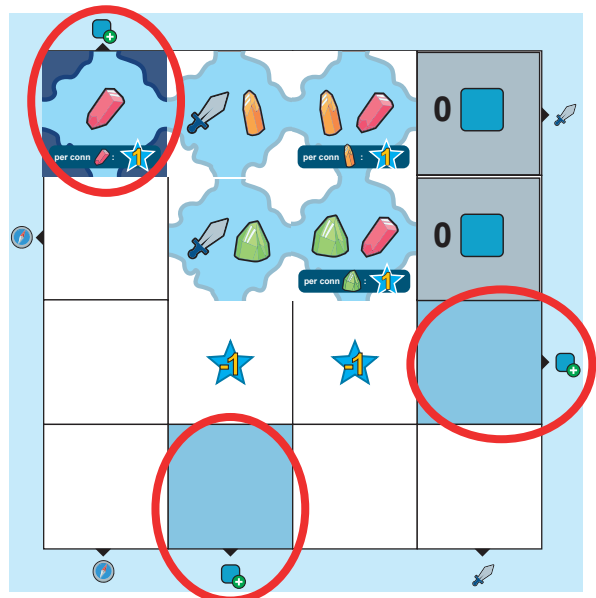
On the last round, skip steps 5 and 6.

Game end

The game ends after the 5th round is complete. The player with most 🏆 wins.

In case of a tie, the player with most  wins.

If the tie persists, the tied players share the victory.



You filled just one  slot (the first one), so you'll have to take a tile from tier 1.